Gemcitabine alone · non-small-cell lung cancer

Gemcitabine aims to control lung cancer and its symptoms. Treatment is reviewed against side effects, your health and your priorities; benefit is not guaranteed.

Locally advanced or metastatic NSCLC in older adults or people with ECOG2 · NCCP 00284 v5 · Document revised 4 November 2026

Your personal plan: this is the standard regimen schedule. Your team confirms your prescribed doses, cycles, treatment changes and appointments in your written plan.

This guide covers the lung indication only. The same NCCP number also covers pancreatic treatment after surgery with a separate six-cycle plan. Use the correct disease-specific plan.

My overall treatment

Gemcitabine is given on Days 1, 8 and 15. Week 4 has no planned dose. Each cycle lasts 28 days. For lung cancer there is no fixed six-cycle limit in this source: continue only while the team considers treatment helpful and tolerable.

Treatment
Days 1, 8, 15; repeat every 28 days. Duration agreed with your team.

Review
Your team reviews benefit and side effects, then agrees whether to continue, pause or change treatment.

A typical 28-day cycle

Day 1	Day 2–7	Day 8	Day 9–14	Day 15	Day 16–28
Gemcitabine only	At home	Gemcitabine only	At home	Gemcitabine only	At home

Timing may change after review. Side effects can occur on any day; there are no guaranteed safe days.

My tests and checks

When	What is checked	Timing / reason
Before	**Blood count, kidneys / liver** Required by regimen	Before first dose; hearing and kidney-clearance tests only if needed
During	**Blood count** Required by regimen	Before each Day 1, 8 and 15 dose
During	**Kidneys / liver** Required by regimen	Before each 28-day cycle
After / review	**Scans, markers and recovery** Team-agreed plan	Individual plan; no fixed scan or tumour-marker interval

Between treatments

- Tiredness, sickness, mouth soreness or a flu-like feeling may occur; follow your prescribed support plan.
- Infection risk is not confined to treatment days. Fever or sudden illness needs immediate advice.

Bring your medicine list and report new symptoms before dosing. Confirm the prescription, test appointments and daytime / out-of-hours contact plan.

When to get help

Call 112 / 999 for severe breathing difficulty, severe chest pain, collapse or a seizure.

Call oncology immediately: temperature 37.5°C or above, 36°C or below, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your hospital's temperature instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment. Do not wait for the next appointment.

Oncology daytime: 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321

EXAMPLE ONLY — team must replace both numbers before patient use.

Feasibility build. Clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Your team confirms your personal plan.

What to watch for

You do not need to know which medicine caused a symptom before calling.

1 Head / alertness

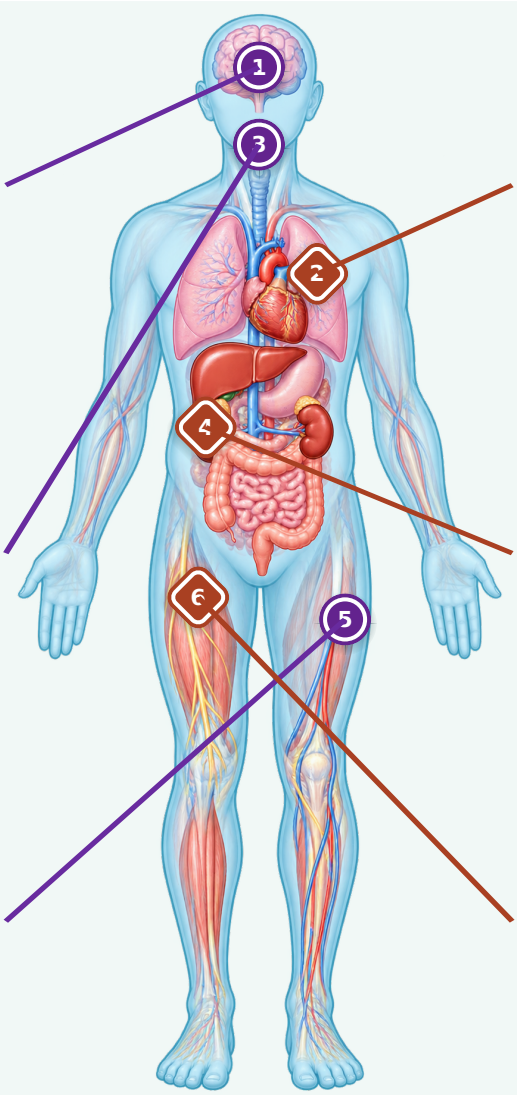
Gemcitabine

Urgent advice for severe headache, confusion, seizures or vision change.

2 Breathing

Gemcitabine

New or worsening breathlessness needs urgent advice.



3 Mouth / sickness

Gemcitabine

Report mouth sores, vomiting or trouble drinking.

4 Kidneys / fluids

Gemcitabine

Call for much less urine, swelling or sudden illness.

5 Skin

Gemcitabine

A spreading rash, blisters or peeling skin needs urgent review.

6 Blood cells

Gemcitabine

Fever, infection symptoms or unusual bleeding need prompt advice.

Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

Call oncology immediately for fever or sudden illness, breathing difficulty, chest pain, uncontrolled vomiting, bleeding, very little urine, severe headache or confusion, or a spreading/blistering rash. Tell the nurse about infusion-site pain.

When to get help

Call 112 / 999 for severe breathing difficulty, severe chest pain, collapse or a seizure.

Call oncology immediately: temperature 37.5°C or above, 36°C or below, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your hospital's temperature instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment. Do not wait for the next appointment.

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Keep your treatment details to hand

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Print this page **one-sided on A4 at Actual size / 100%**. Cut only the dashed outer border around both panels. **Do not cut the centre line.** Fold with FRONT and BACK facing out, then glue or tape the blank backs together. Finished size: **85.6 × 54 mm**. Keep the stamp side writable.

FRONT / CONTACTS

My Treatment Card

SACTCheck

Name: _____

Gemcitabine

Days 1, 8, 15; repeat every 28 days. Duration agreed with your team.

Phase: _____ Cycle plan: team to confirm

Daytime (EXAMPLE) 087 12345678
Out of hours (EXAMPLE) 087 87654321

Unwell or fever? Call oncology now.
Severe breathing difficulty, chest pain or collapse: **112 / 999.**

EXAMPLE NUMBERS — replace before patient use.

CUT outer border

BACK / TREATMENT RECORD

My cycle record

Rolling record — follow your agreed treatment plan.

Cycle	Date / initials

My treatment information

Latest treatment date: _____

Plan changed? Ask the team to update this card.

FOLD centre — do not cut

Keep the record accurate

The team dates and initials each recorded treatment unit when complete. A cycle is complete after its final planned dose; a weekly-treatment stamp records that weekly dose. Delays, omitted doses or a changed plan need a note or a replacement card. A stamp does not approve the next treatment. Keep any medicine-specific alert card too.

Put your treatment page on your phone

Scan your QR and check the treatment name. Save that page to your home screen.

iPhone / Safari

Tap Share → Add to Home Screen. Select Open as Web App if offered, then Add.

Android / Chrome

Tap the three-dot menu → Add to Home screen or Install and create shortcut. Choose the shortcut option and confirm.

Menu wording varies. The QR opens information, not a personal record. Paper stamps do not update the website. Check that the saved icon opens the correct treatment.

Your local contacts and resources

Oncology daytime: 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321

EXAMPLE ONLY — team must replace both numbers before patient use.

Hospital / team: _____
Backup if the team cannot be reached: _____

Additional local services and resources will be added when confirmed. Your team must check and complete this page before patient use.

Feasibility build. Clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Your team confirms your personal plan.